

Yes, I have Depression!

Depression is just a term for people who never had the experience in life. They do not know how it feels and what the person goes through when they have an episode. It's very easy for them to say, it's just depression, what's the big deal? People without depression usually think it is not a disability, that depression patients need more attention.

First let's talk about, what is Depression? It is a medical condition in which the patient has a serotonin and dopamine imbalance in the brain, which are the molecules that send signals in the body to feel pleasure and happiness. They do not have control over their emotions, and don't feel uplifted or worthy of anything, because they do not have enough chemical release in the body to feel the nice things around them or even feel loved. People around them don't understand and judge them for not being thankful and not putting effort in to making emotional bonds. This kind of judgmental behavior even throws them into darker places, where they can harm themselves or others too. This doesn't mean they are sociopaths or dangerous to society; they are people who need someone's help to pull them out from that state. They need someone who can listen to them and feel safe and loved. They also need help from their medical providers, who can help them with selecting the right medication and dose to appropriately increase their serotonin and dopamine levels, so they can come back to their normal self-being.

I am a second year Pharmacy student, and we have recently finished our study about depression. When I was learning about depression, I understood how difficult it is to identify or diagnose even for a provider about this disease state. Depression can overlap with a lot of other problems too, or it can be just major depression disorder, or it can be bipolar depression disorder. Even after the right diagnosis it is not very easy to manage or dose everyone in the same manner, because every person is different and need different kinds of treatment. While studying about depression I learned how important a role pharmacists play in the patient care process.. It is very important for us to understand the disease state and help providers design care for each patient accordingly. We learn how some medications have other side effects which can not bring better outcomes for certain age groups or biological gender. Those adverse effects can become adherence issues for the patient or make their condition worse by invoking new problems.

I am applying for IP is BEST certification program because I want to learn more about depression and its related problems so I can provide the best care possible for my patients. I also have noticed in my personal and professional life how hard it is for a patient to say, "Yes, I have depression and I need help!" because it is not an easy task for anyone to ask for help when they are feeling depressed and they are feeling their worst. I think we need to provide more awareness for people to understand and identify if any of their family members or friends are not feeling like themselves and cannot ask for help. The family members and friends should empower the depression patients to come forward for help. Family and friends should hold

their hand and show the support and courage to get the help they need. I think with the education of this program I will gain more knowledge to understand my patient and also will learn about the resources available from the state and social department to help my patients.